

# 08 The past simple negative

The past simple negative is used to talk about things that did not happen in the past. It is always formed the same way, unless the main verb is "be."

See also:

Past simple 7 Present simple negative 2

Types of verbs 49

## 8.1 THE PAST SIMPLE NEGATIVE

The past simple negative uses "did not" or "didn't" with the base form of the main verb. The main verb is not put into the past simple.

I played tennis last week, but I **didn't** play yesterday.



"played" is the past simple.

To make the negative, "didn't" is used with the base form.



LAST WEEK

YESTERDAY

TODAY

## HOW TO FORM

SUBJECT

"DID NOT / DIDN'T"

BASE FORM OF VERB

REST OF SENTENCE

I

**didn't**

go

swimming.

"Didn't" or "did not" are used to make the negative, no matter what the subject is.

The base form of the main verb is used in the past simple negative.

## FURTHER EXAMPLES



You **didn't** like the beach.

I **didn't** eat all the chocolate!



They **didn't** buy the big, expensive car.

Emily **didn't** enjoy the theme park as much as Zara.



She **did not** talk to anyone before the exam.

"Did not" is only used for emphasis, or in formal situations.

Hugh **did not** cycle to work today.

